



Spirit of **INDIA**
Youth Special

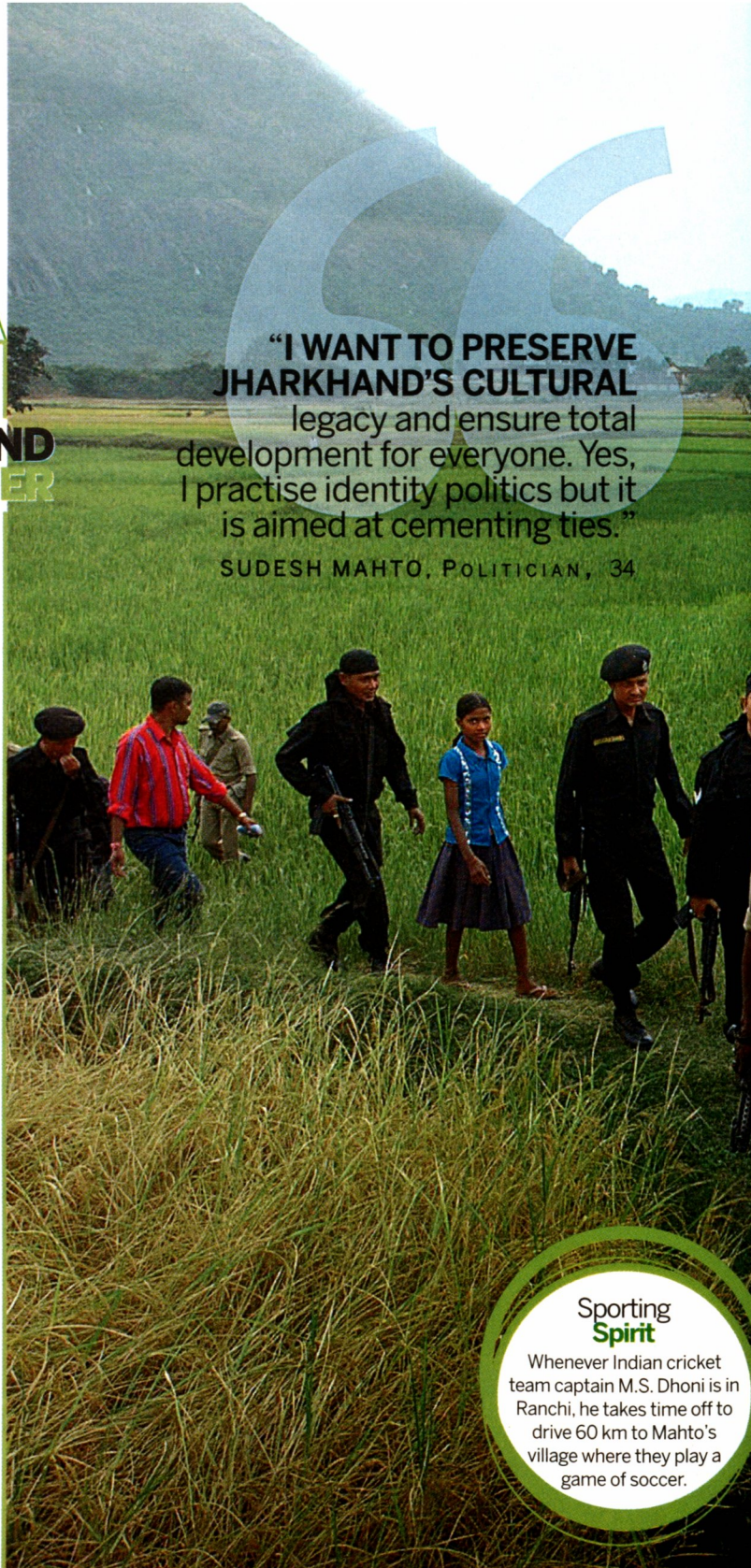
MOBILISE AND EMPOWER

THEY HAVE redefined the tags that are commonly associated with today's youth and overturned convention.

This is the politically driven youth with an active social consciousness. So if there is a woman from Manipur working against gun violence, there is another, a young panchayat member, fighting the land mafia despite physical threats in Kerala.

There is a young former minister from Jharkhand driving change, a group of young IIT and IIM professionals who jumped into the political arena and set up their own party, and even an activist couple working in Uttar Pradesh, fighting for the Dalits, having taken up over 350 cases on their behalf.

There is the young writer who is leading a movement in Bundelkhand to fight famine. Then there are various student leaders getting ready to jump into the national arena, striving for change, representing different communities and thought processes that make up this country. It is a realisation that has forced the youth to look outside the boundaries of its colleges, universities and comfort zones. It has enabled them to find their voice and use it as a powerful force for change.



"I WANT TO PRESERVE JHARKHAND'S CULTURAL legacy and ensure total development for everyone. Yes, I practise identity politics but it is aimed at cementing ties."

SUDESH MAHTO, POLITICIAN, 34

Sporting Spirit

Whenever Indian cricket team captain M.S. Dhoni is in Ranchi, he takes time off to drive 60 km to Mahto's village where they play a game of soccer.